Mud Creek, Grayson County VA, parcel 6273 (PTM 63-A-62)

29.31 ac · Graded

Graded on an earlier boundary: the parcel's lines changed after this grade. Grade it again for a current report card.



Filled: the best site · Imagery: USGS (public domain) · Imagery: Esri, Maxar, Earthstar Geographics

B **Contender** · Profile 1: Strong elevation and winter sun; 0.1 ac of garden ground, under your 0.25 ac; check first: septic.

MUST HAVE

Floodplain	✓	A FEMA flood zone covers 0.5 ac of the parcel, away from the build site and driveway
Legal road access	✓	Frontage on Mud Creek Ln
Driveway on your land	✓	The driveway stays on the parcel
Septic	!	Check first: no soil on the parcel rates better than very limited for a septic field

REALLY WANT

Elevation at the build site	A	3,543 ft at site #1
Best homesite	A	faces W, 8.3 h of December sun, 7° slope
Room to build	B	1.0 ac of gentle ground near the house site, 2.1× the build footprint
Night sky	A	rural dark sky (zone 3a)
Trails and public land	B	a trailhead 17 min (6.7 mi) by road, 5.0 mi straight (Grayson Highlands State Park)
Garden ground	C	the largest garden is 0.10 ac
Town and hospital	C	a 38-minute drive to an ER, 21 to a grocery

QUESTIONS FOR THE AGENT

1. Has the land had a perc test or a soil evaluation? Is a conventional septic system possible?

Still unknown not in any dataset

- [ ] Legal access: deeded, recorded, width, maintenance agreement
- [ ] Deed restrictions / CC&Rs — read the actual recorded document
- [ ] Severed mineral or timber rights — check the deed chain, not the listing
- [ ] Utility extension quote from the power co-op, by parcel ID
- [ ] Neighboring well depths and yields (county health department)
- [ ] Septic: get a soil scientist's opinion on the bench, not the pin
- [ ] Whether RV or shop-house occupancy during the build is lawful (zoning office)
- [ ] Homeowner's insurance quote for the address before you fall in love
- [ ] Cell service and the Starlink sky view from the bench

THE PRIORITIES IT WAS GRADED AGAINST

Must have

- No flood zone at the house or the driveway
- Reachable by a public road, or a recorded right-of-way
- The driveway stays on your land, or its easement is recorded
- Soil that can take a septic field

Really want

1. **Elevation at the build site** (25%): 2,500 ft or higher
2. **Best homesite** (25%): A sunny, gentle spot for the house
3. **Room to build** (15%): Enough gentle ground for the house
4. **Night sky** (10%): Dark enough to see the Milky Way
5. **Trails and public land** (10%): A trailhead within 20 min, or public land within 1 mi
6. **Garden ground** (10%): Room for a kitchen garden
7. **Town and hospital** (5%): ER within 30 min, groceries within 20 min

Don't care: Driveway

BEST SITE AND ALTERNATIVES

1. **1st · Site #1**: Elevation 3,543 ft · Winter sun 8.3 h sun, faces W · Room to build 2.1× footprint · Night sky zone 3a
2. **2nd · Site #3**: Elevation 3,532 ft · Winter sun 8.0 h sun, faces NW · Room to build 2.1× footprint · Night sky zone 3a
3. **3rd · Site #2**: Elevation 3,508 ft · Winter sun 8.3 h sun, faces SW · Room to build 0.7× footprint · Night sky zone 3a
4. **4th · Site #4**: Elevation 3,299 ft · Winter sun 7.9 h sun, faces S · Room to build house only · Night sky zone 3a

Where to build ranked from the data

1 Best site — A site — $$$$ to build

overall 66 · 3,543 ft · 36.58632, -81.56041

sun **87** aspect **57** frost **88** slope **94** sky **73** driveway **2,888 ft**

- 8.3 h of December sun — good
- 1.3 ac, faces W, 7.0° slope, 650 ft above the valley floor
- Pigeonroost: septic rated very limited — alternative system, rock near the surface
- routed driveway: 2888 ft at ≤15%, 5 switchbacks, ~$116–216k

2 Runner-up (compact) — A site — $$$$ to build

overall 62 · 3,508 ft · 36.58586, -81.56128

sun **87** aspect **90** frost **89** slope **56** sky **75** driveway **2,578 ft**

- compact site: 0.46 ac shelf — needs a cut pad and probably a retaining wall
- 8.3 h of December sun — good
- 0.5 ac, faces SW, 13.0° slope, 615 ft above the valley floor
- Pigeonroost: septic rated very limited — alternative system, rock near the surface
- 804 ft to Mud Creek Ln at 35% straight-line — about 1870 ft of driveway with switchbacks
- routed driveway: 2578 ft at ≤15%, 6 switchbacks, ~$114–211k

3 Third (compact) — B site — $$$$ to build

overall 58 · 3,532 ft · 36.58657, -81.56058

sun **85** aspect **44** frost **88** slope **71** sky **73** driveway **2,845 ft**

- compact site: 0.63 ac shelf — needs a cut pad and probably a retaining wall
- 8.0 h of December sun — good
- 0.6 ac, faces NW, 10.6° slope, 639 ft above the valley floor
- Pigeonroost: septic rated very limited — alternative system, rock near the surface
- 556 ft to unnamed road at 15% straight-line — about 564 ft of driveway with switchbacks
- routed driveway: 2845 ft at ≤15%, 5 switchbacks, ~$114–211k

Side by side

Site	Quality	Sun h	Aspect	Frost	Slope	Sky	Cost	Septic	Found.	Rock	Pad	Driveway	Overall
#1	**A** 82	8.3	57	88	94	73	**$$$$** 70	40	0	8.4	1	2,888 ft (20)	66
#2 compact	**A** 82	8.3	90	89	56	75	**$$$$** 83	40	0	8.4	15	2,578 ft (20)	62
#3 compact	**B** 75	8.0	44	88	71	73	**$$$$** 83	40	0	8.4	15	2,845 ft (20)	58
#4 compact	**A** 85	7.9	100	100	67	75	**$$$$** 76	40	0	8.4	15	905 ft (12)	67

Quality is the spot itself — sun 40, aspect/frost/slope/sky 15 each — and can't be bought. Cost is what it takes to build there, as points toward 100: septic class, foundation rating, rock, pad cutting, driveway length and grade. A great spot with a long driveway is an A site at $$$, not a D.

Shelves for a shop, barn or garage

- **S1** — 0.63 ac at 3,532 ft, faces NW, 10.6° slope, cell score 52; 101 ft from site #1, down 11 ft
- **S2** — 0.46 ac at 3,508 ft, faces SW, 13.0° slope, cell score 52; 305 ft from site #1, down 35 ft
- **S3** — 0.24 ac at 3,299 ft, faces S, 11.3° slope, cell score 66; 980 ft from site #1, down 245 ft
- **S4** — 0.13 ac at 3,343 ft, faces SSW, 13.2° slope, cell score 53; 849 ft from site #1, down 200 ft
- **S5** — 0.12 ac at 3,384 ft, faces SSE, 12.3° slope, cell score 60; 503 ft from site #1, down 159 ft

A shelf is ground that scores 45+ but is too small or too shaded for a house — fine for a building you don't live in. Watch the drop from the house: 60 ft down over 400 ft is a 15% driveway.

Excluded

- 0.3 ac at 36.58522, -81.56419 — Codorus: frequently flooded. NRCS says no, whatever FEMA says.

Ranked by overall = 70% site quality + 30% (100 − cost). It ranks the ground the terrain scan found; it doesn't know about views, wells, or the neighbor's dog.

Terrain

Elevation	3,165–3,555 ft (mean 3,374)
Relief across the parcel	390 ft
Height above local valley floor	471 ft (floor 2,894 ft)
Slope, median / 90th pct	21.9° / 27.5°
Acres under 15% grade	1.3 of 30.1
Acres over 25% grade	25.6
House sites found	2 (1.59 ac) · shelves 5 · garden patches 1
Largest house site	1.28 ac at 3,543 ft, faces W, 7.0° slope, cell score 73
Nearest road to bench	unnamed road: drop 72 ft over 614 ft (12% straight-line)

Of 30.1 ac: 2.2 ac score ≥60 for a house, 2.2 ac more ≥45 (shelf grade), 0.3 ac ≥60 for a garden. DEM: USGS 3DEP at 3.0 m.

ACCESS AND DRIVEWAY

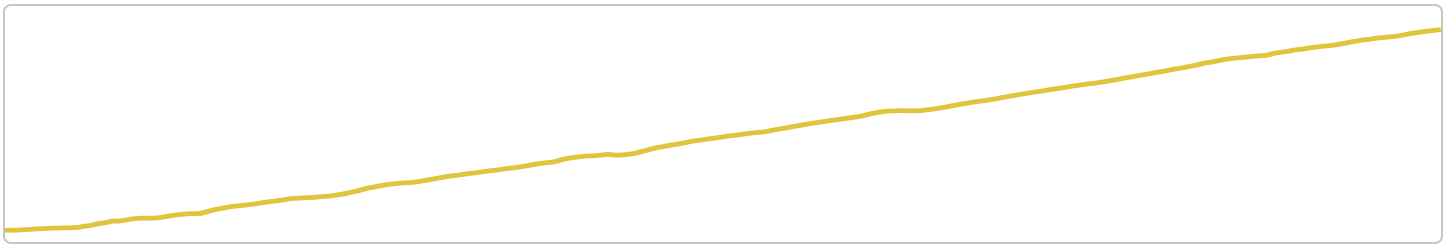
- **Legal road access:** Frontage on Mud Creek Ln
- **Driveway on your land:** The driveway stays on the parcel

Driveway routed to site #1

Entrance candidates on the frontage (E1 best): E1 Mud Creek Ln — road 4%, bend 4°, bank 6 ft; E2 Mud Creek Ln — road 2%, bend 25°, bank 16 ft; E3 Mud Creek Ln — road 3%, bend 20°, bank 19 ft.

Recommended — shortest legal from E2 **$116–216k**

Length / rise	2,888 ft / 337 ft
Grade over 30 m / average	17.9% / 11.9% (limit 15%)
Switchbacks	5
Earthwork	1,868 yd^3 (434 yd^3 in rock)
Stone	884 tons (12 ft × 6 in)
Clearing corridor	1.59 ac
Culverts	1 (entrance + 0 drainage crossings)
Relief culverts	14 (one every 150–400 ft, by grade)
Paving (over 12%)	~2,185 ft (cost TBD)



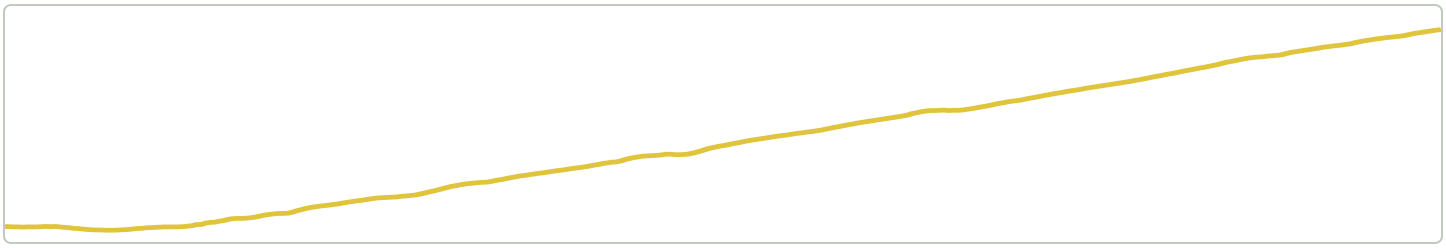
▼ Grade over 15 and 60 m

Grade over 15 m	20.8%
Grade over 60 m	15.6%

Grades are measured on the ground under the route, between the DEM's cells. A built road's grade reads about 1–4 points lower, once cut and fill smooth the ground.

Alternative — shortest legal from E1 **$121–224k**

Length / rise	3,109 ft / 331 ft
Grade over 30 m / average	17.8% / 11.3% (limit 15%)
Switchbacks	5
Earthwork	1,882 yd^3 (420 yd^3 in rock)
Stone	951 tons (12 ft × 6 in)
Clearing corridor	1.71 ac
Culverts	2 (entrance + 1 drainage crossing)
Relief culverts	14 (one every 150–400 ft, by grade)
Paving (over 12%)	~2,283 ft (cost TBD)



▼ Grade over 15 and 60 m

Grade over 15 m	20.7%
Grade over 60 m	15.6%

Grades are measured on the ground under the route, between the DEM's cells. A built road's grade reads about 1–4 points lower, once cut and fill smooth the ground.

Pioneer 4×4 track first

On the driveway's alignment (keeps the dozer work)	~27 machine hours, 18 water bars · **$12–23k**
Direct line at ≤15% (red dotted; cheaper now, replaced later)	2,879 ft, 18% over 30 m · **$12–23k**

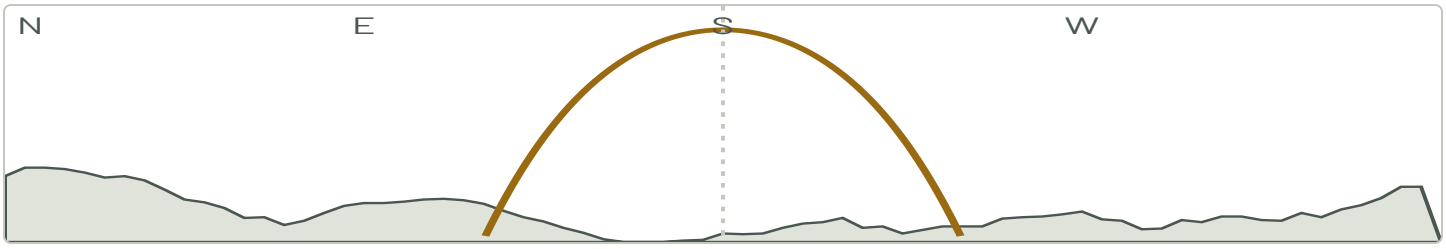
A track is blade width, native soil, water bars instead of ditches, a pipe or ford at crossings, stone only at the entrance. Building it on the final alignment means the earthwork carries forward; the direct line is money spent twice.

Least-cost route over the 3 m lidar with a hard grade limit; it avoids bottomland and side-hill, and prices crossings as culverts. Costs use the unit rates in Settings, ±30%. Bare-earth DEM (no trees), county soils (not borings), and VDOT decides the entrance — this is a number to put in front of an excavator, not a bid.

WINTER SUN AND THE HORIZON

December sun at the largest house site, 3,546 ft

This point	3,546 ft elevation, 652 ft above the valley floor, 5.3° slope facing NNW · 36.58632, -81.56041



Direct sun, Dec 21	8.3 of 9.5 daylight hours
Noon sun altitude / worst southern ridge	30.0° / 5.4° at 120° (ESE)
Noon clearance (after 3° canopy)	21.6°
Direct sun, Jun 21	13.3 of 14.5 h

Grey is bare-earth terrain from lidar; trees add to it.

NIGHT SKY

Dark skies score 73/100 at the largest house site

Sky at zenith	21.52 mag/arcsec^2 — zone 3a, rural dark
Artificial vs natural light	0.56× (1.0 = half the sky's light is man-made)
Milky Way core, peak altitude	24.4° above due south
Southern ridge / clearance	3.4° / 18.0° (after 3° canopy)
Brightest patch to the south	3.47× at 15 mi, bearing 165° (SSE)

- The core peaks 24° above due south; the ridge there is 3° — 18° of clear sky under it.
- Bright patch toward SSE at 15 mi (ratio 3.5): expect a light dome low in the SSE exactly where the core sits.

Zenith brightness from the Light Pollution Atlas 2025 (Lorenz, after Falchi/Cinzano), 1/120° grid. The atlas is zenith-only, so the southern-dome line samples the ground map toward the core as a proxy. The core is up in the evening from June to September.

SOILS, SEPTIC AND FLOOD

Soils what the ground will let you do

NRCS mapped the county into units. Each unit is a mix of soils they expect you'd find if you dug. Slope in the unit name tells you which part of the parcel it is.

Pigeonroost gravelly loam, 35 to 55 percent slopes, very stony 16.5 ac inside the line

Pigeonroost 85% of this unit

House & septic — Too steep for a house or drainfield without heavy earthwork. Rock at 94 cm — budget for excavation.
Garden & animals — Woodlot. Goats will browse it; nothing else belongs there.

Well drained; septic "Very limited"; house w/ basement "Very limited"; no basement "Very limited"; roads "Very limited"; flooding None; bedrock 94 cm; hydric No

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Pigeonroost loam, 35 to 55 percent slopes 10.4 ac inside the line

Pigeonroost 85% of this unit

House & septic — Too steep for a house or drainfield without heavy earthwork. Rock at 94 cm — budget for excavation.
Garden & animals — Woodlot. Goats will browse it; nothing else belongs there.

Well drained; septic "Very limited"; house w/ basement "Very limited"; no basement "Very limited"; roads "Very limited"; flooding None; bedrock 94 cm; hydric No

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Pigeonroost loam, 15 to 35 percent slopes 2.0 ac inside the line

Pigeonroost 85% of this unit

House & septic — Too steep for a house or drainfield without heavy earthwork. Rock at 94 cm — budget for excavation.
Garden & animals — Woodlot. Goats will browse it; nothing else belongs there.

Well drained; septic "Very limited"; house w/ basement "Very limited"; no basement "Very limited"; roads "Very limited"; flooding None; bedrock 94 cm; hydric No

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Codorus loam, 0 to 3 percent slopes, frequently flooded 0.8 ac inside the line

Codorus 90% of this unit

House & septic — Floods (frequent) — no house, no drainfield.
Garden & animals — Wet pasture or hay; a garden will drown here.

Somewhat poorly drained; septic "Very limited"; house w/ basement "Very limited"; no basement "Very limited"; roads "Very limited"; flooding Frequent; water table ≥45 cm; bedrock not recorded; hydric No

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Tate loam, 7 to 15 percent slopes 0.3 ac inside the line

Tate 90% of this unit · farmland of statewide importance

House & septic — Buildable with some site work; skip the basement. NRCS rates a drainfield here very limited — plan on an alternative system and a perc test before offering.
Garden & animals — Good garden and pasture ground.

Well drained; septic "Very limited"; house w/ basement "Somewhat limited"; no basement "Somewhat limited"; roads "Somewhat limited"; flooding None; bedrock not recorded; hydric No

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Edneyville loam, 25 to 45 percent slopes 0.2 ac inside the line

Edneyville 80% of this unit

House & septic — Too steep for a house or drainfield without heavy earthwork.
Garden & animals — Woodlot. Goats will browse it; nothing else belongs there.

Well drained; septic "Very limited"; house w/ basement "Very limited"; no basement "Very limited"; roads "Very limited"; flooding None; bedrock not recorded; hydric No

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Map-unit lines are drawn at county scale, so a boundary can be 100 ft off on the ground.

Floodplain

0.5 acres in a Special Flood Hazard Area (zones A, X).

Where to garden frost-safe, sunny, gentle, good dirt

G1 **0.10 ac** B 76/100 · 3,549 ft, 656 ft above the valley floor · faces WSW, 2.6° · well drained (Pigeonroost)

Garden score weighs frost position heavily: cold air drains downhill on still clear nights and pools in the low ground, where the last spring frost comes weeks later and the first fall frost weeks earlier. Slope ≤6° and a southern face do the rest; soil drainage and NRCS farmland class adjust the score.

DRIVE TIMES

Getting there and getting out

Nearest hospital Ashe Memorial Hospital	38 min, 19 mi
Nearest real grocery Food Lion	38 min, 19 mi Closer: Lansing Foods, 21 min.
Asheville airport (AVL)	202 min, 157.9 mi
Roanoke airport (ROA)	173 min, 132 mi
Tri-Cities airport (TRI)	93 min, 67.2 mi
Greenville-Spartanburg (GSP)	255 min, 164.7 mi
Charlotte airport (CLT)	195 min, 139.9 mi
Groceries within 28 mi (straight line)	Lansing Foods 7 mi Food Lion 13 mi The Corner Market 13 mi Food City 14 mi Walmart Supercenter 14 mi Ingles 15 mi
Trailheads within 22 mi	20 (nearest 4.9 mi)

Drive times from OSRM's public router — fine for comparing parcels, not for catching a flight. Places come from OpenStreetMap data (via Photon); trailhead counts undercount national forest access. Roads from the Census Bureau's TIGER lines. Forest Service trailheads and state parks are included too. Drive times start at the driveway's entrance on Mud Creek Ln.

Public land within a mile

- NC Land and Water Fund Conservation Agreement — 3,345 ft away; access restricted

Conservation easements on private land are not in this layer and don't count — you can't walk on them.

Nearest public land open to visitors beyond a mile: Jefferson National Forest (U.S. Forest Service), 2.3 mi straight-line.

LISTING FACTS AND NOTES

No listing facts yet.

LINES AND MARKS

None drawn.

DATA SOURCES

- USGS 3DEP lidar (USGS 3DEP, 3 m): as of the screen
- NRCS soils (Soil Data Access): as of the screen
- FEMA flood map (NFHL): as of the screen
- USGS PAD-US (public land): as of the screen

- Light pollution atlas (D. Lorenz, 2025)
- Census TIGER roads: as of the screen
- OpenStreetMap places and trailheads: as of the screen
- OSRM drive times: as of the screen

Graded by engine version 22.

This is a desk screen, not a survey, perc test or appraisal.